WORKING NOTES · ETHGLOBAL MUMBAI 2026

ETHGlobal Mumbai 2026: Everything We Worked Out

Event facts, prize maths, what wins, our past project, every idea we tested and why, and the plan for the next 36 hours

> **How to use this document**
> Parts 1–2 are the facts: logistics, judging and prize money. Parts 3–4 are the research: what won in Tokyo, ETHOnline and Delhi, and how deep projects need to be. Part 5 is Fiducia. Part 6 is every idea we considered, with the verdict on each. Parts 7–9 are the plan: who to talk to, how to decide and how to scope the build.

Compiled 5 Nov 2026 from our conversation, the ETHGlobal Mumbai prize and info pages, the ETHGlobal showcase (Tokyo 2026, ETHOnline 2026, New Delhi 2025), the Fiducia repo and Drive docs, and the news and data sources listed at the end. Dollar figures are sponsor prizes in USD or USDC. Estimates and judgment calls are labelled as such.

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1. The event

Key facts

Item	Detail
Dates	Thursday 5 – Saturday 7 November 2026, all times IST
Venue	Jio World Convention Centre, Pavilion 2, Jio World Centre, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai 400098
Your status	Fully confirmed (checked by logging in to the hacker dashboard with the magic link from your inbox). Discord connected, hacker pack claimed. Build track (from scratch or continuity) not yet selected.
Ticket	PDF attached to the "Your ticket for ETHGlobal Mumbai!" email; can be added to Apple or Google Wallet
ID	Valid photo ID matching the name on the ticket; you get a badge and wristband
What to bring	Laptop, charger, Indian plug adapters, Ethernet dongle if no Ethernet port, a hoodie or light blanket
Size	Event page states 800+ attendees, 11+ protocols, 29+ workshops, $175,000 in prizes
Staying overnight	Allowed, with limits. FAQ: "limited, first-come, first-serve spaces where attendees can sleep, but... not the most comfortable... no showering facilities". A nearby hotel (e.g. ibis Mumbai BKC, about 1.4 km) is a good backup.

Schedule

When	What
Thu 1:00 PM	Registration opens (Pavilion 2); closes 10:00 PM
Thu 2:30–6:00 PM	Sponsor workshops: Hedera × Claude Code (3:30, Room 2), 0G (3:30, Room 1), ENSv2 (4:00, Room 1), Arkiv (4:00, Room 2), Uniswap (4:30, Room 1), Whitechain (4:30, Room 2), Arc (5:00, Room 1), Ethereum Foundation (5:00, Room 2), World (5:30, Room 1), 1inch Aqua (5:30, Room 2)
Thu 6:30 PM	Dinner
Thu 8:00 PM	Opening ceremony, with a fireside chat with Balaji Srinivasan
Thu 9:00 PM	**Hacking begins**
Thu 9:30 PM	Team formation session
Thu/Fri midnight	Late-night snacks
Fri	Brunch 10 AM; optional Diwali activities from 1 PM (lanterns, diya painting, mehndi); dinner 6 PM
Sat 8:00 AM	Breakfast
Sat 9:00 AM	**Project submissions due**
Sat 9:30 AM–12:30 PM	Partner prize judging and main finalist judging
Sat 12:30 PM	Lunch
Sat 3:15 PM	Finalists notified

Sat 3:30 PM	Closing ceremony; event ends 6:00 PM

How judging works

- **Finalist judging:** each team gets **7 minutes: a 4-minute demo, then 3 minutes of questions**. Many rooms run in parallel; each can see about 25 teams in 3 hours, so this is a first-round screen.
- **Criteria (five):** technicality, originality, practicality (complete and usable today), usability (UI/UX/DX) and "WOW factor".
- **Sponsor prizes are judged from your submission materials.** Booth visits are optional. With about 100 entries per sponsor, three hours means **under 2 minutes per project**, so the write-up, the per-sponsor explanation in the form and the video do most of the work.
- Prepare for: "What inspired your project?", "What tools did you use, and why?", "What challenges did you solve, and how?"

Rules that can disqualify you

- **From scratch:** all project work must start after hacking begins; public libraries and starter kits are fine. Pre-built projects only qualify through a continuity track.
- **Continuity tracks** (extend open source you maintain, or ship a feature): document pre-existing work clearly.
- **Version control:** commit often. "Large single commits or missing histories may be disqualified."
- **AI tools allowed, with attribution:** state where and how AI was used, by file. Projects built entirely by AI may lose eligibility. If you use a spec-driven workflow, include all spec files and prompts.
- **Up to 3 partner prizes**; several tracks from one partner count as one.
- **Demo video:** optional but strongly recommended; 2–4 minutes, at least 720p, not sped up, no phone recording, no AI voiceover, no music-with-text instead of talking.

How many people and projects

Event	Hackers	Projects
New Delhi 2025 (advertised 800+)	1,539	616 (614 in the showcase)
Tokyo 2026 (advertised 800+)	800+	254
ETHOnline 2026 (online)	—	812
Mumbai 2026 (estimate)	**about 800–1,500**	**about 250–600**

Ten finalist spots means roughly 1 in 25 to 1 in 60 projects. Mumbai also falls in Devcon week, so the upper end is more likely.

2. Prize structure

Mumbai: how the money is split

$175,000 advertised. Sponsor prizes add up to about $144,500 by our count (12 sponsors); the rest is ETHGlobal's own finalist pool.

Finalist rewards (new this event):

Team size	Cash	Travel credit
Solo	$250 per person	none
2 people	$250 per person	$250 per person
3–5 people	**$1,000 per person**	**$500 per person**

Travel credit is for one in-person ETHGlobal hackathon within 365 days. A 4-person finalist team gets $4,000 cash plus $2,000 travel.

Sponsor tracks (Mumbai)

Sponsor	Total	Tracks and places
Uniswap	$15,000	Build with Uniswap: $4k / $3k / $2k / $1k. Continuity: 4 × $1,250
World	$12,500	Agent Pass Portal $5,000 (split not stated); Agent Pass continuity $2,500; IDKit 2 × $1,250; IDKit continuity 2 × $1,250. Brief: "a meaningful action that needs a human identity or approval layer, not simply a login screen". Proofs are mocked at this event.
0G	$15,000	Build with 0G PC (consumer app): $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k. Physical AI: $2.5k / $1.5k + $1k best real hardware (robot, drone, wearable or pocket device; simulated builds eligible; rejects "chatbot with a robot avatar, pre-recorded motion, 0G used only for logs"). Keep Building (existing 0G projects): 2 × $1,500. Agents That Pay for Themselves: 2 × $1,000. Paid at 0G's discretion.
Arc	$15,000	Five $3,000 tracks: DeFi app in Arc Studio; mobile consumer agent using the marketplace discovery API; advanced stablecoin contracts; Bridge Kit for non-USDC assets; continuity. Every Arc prize must start in Arc Studio.
Hedera	$15,000	AI agents that pay (x402): $3k / $2k / $1.5k. Tokenize anything (Hedera Studios): $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k. No Solidity: 2 × $1,000. Continuity: 2 × $750
Arkiv	$15,000	Mirror something Ethereum depends on: $3k / $1k. Build on Arkiv: $3k / $1k. Existing projects: $3k / $1k. Node tooling $2k. Swarm bonus $500 (from scratch) and $500 (existing). All Arkiv tracks count as one pick. Judged partly from files: schema.md, friction.md, reach.md, why-arkiv.md, data-quality.md
Whitechain	$15,000	Stablecoin payments for business: $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k. Tokenize real-world finance: $2.5k / $1.5k. Payments nobody notices (no gas for payer): $2k / $1k. Continuity: $1.5k / $1.5k
Ethereum Foundation	$15,000	Anon-RPC: $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k. Frame-transaction alternative mempool: $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k. CROPS app: $2k / $1k / $500. CROPS upgrade (continuity): $1.5k. At most one EF prize per project.
ENS	$10,000	Best use of ENSv2: $3k / $2k / $1k. ENSv2 in an existing project: $2k / $1k. Must be ENSv2 on mainnet or Sepolia, central not cosmetic, live demo, open source, no hard-coded values.

1inch	$7,000	Aqua app: $2.5k / $1.5k / $1k (custom SwapVM opcodes allowed). Continuity: $1.5k / $500
Definitive	$5,000	Flash advanced orders in a social app $2,500; most creative use of Flash (continuity) $2,500
Chainlink	$5,000	Best CRE workflow $1,500; CCIP 2.0: 2 × $1,750 (CCIP state change required for core prizes)

Continuity-only money: about $34,000 of the $144,500 (about 24%). From-scratch projects compete for about $110,000.

Mumbai compared with earlier events

	Mumbai 2026	New Delhi 2025	Tokyo 2026	ETHOnline 2026
Advertised pool	$175,000	$200,000	$75,000	not stated
Sponsor prizes (our sum)	about $144,500	about $189,000	$52,500	$80,000
Sponsors	12	21	7	11
Typical sponsor total	$15k (9 of 12)	$10k (15 of 21)	$5–15k	$3–15k
Biggest 1st place	$4,000 (Uniswap)	$6,000 (1inch)	$3,000	$2,500
Finalist cash	**Yes, $250–1,000 per person**	No (perks only)	$17k shared by top 10	No
Finalist travel	$250–500 per person	$500 per person	No	n/a
Continuity-only share	about $34k (24%)	none	about $12k (23%)	about $15k (19%)

Tokyo finalists also got a full Devcon Mumbai pass; all events gave $10,000 AWS credits, a hoodie and an ETHGlobal Plus discount.

3. What wins

We went through every prize winner on the ETHGlobal showcase: Tokyo 2026 (254 projects, 29 winners, 8 finalist badges), ETHOnline 2026 (812 projects, 63 winners, 8 finalist badges) and New Delhi 2025 (614 projects, 88 winners, 10 finalists).

Finalists

Tokyo 2026	What it is	Also won
Omamoris	Agent gets a budget and an intent, not your keys; one World App approval	—
yohaku	Routes agent requests so only what needs a human reaches one	—
Takarabako	Raspberry Pi kiosk turns leftover travel cash into dollar savings	1inch continuity 2nd
OddsFlow	One balance backs many prediction-market bets	1inch Aqua 1st
Kura	Real Magic cards vaulted, shards sold to verified humans in a Uniswap auction	Uniswap 1st, ENS 3rd
Patio Station	Live radio broadcast through Ethereum's mempool	—
watermark	DAO treasury becomes a market maker via 1inch Aqua with custom opcodes	1inch Aqua 3rd
Enconomy	Two phones prove proximity with sound + on-device ZK proof	—

ETHOnline 2026	What it is	Also won
TARE	Measures what Uniswap v4 hooks take: 125,072 replayable measurements	Uniswap
OpenBook	Data marketplace for agents: fresh data or your money back	The Graph 3rd, Arc
OnchainRouter	"OpenRouter for onchain tools", pay per call, no answer no charge	—
Cordon	Budgets for trees of agents; spend debited up the whole chain	—
Petri	Evolves agent harnesses; only verified improvements survive	—
Novi Corpus	A Wyoming LLC for an AI agent, with a human guardian	World AgentKit (continuity)
ETH Arcade	Raspberry Pi handheld where the ETH price is the game	—
LeekWallet	ESP32 hardware wallet that refuses what it can't display	—

Eight patterns in what won

1. **Agents everywhere, but the winners make agents safe, not just powerful** (at least 38 of 63 ETHOnline winners and 10 of 29 Tokyo winners involve agents): caps, pre-signing checks, human approval, insurance or legal accountability.
2. **Physical demos punch above their weight for finalist spots:** 5 of 16 finalists had real hardware or objects.
3. **Finalist and sponsor judges reward different things:** 9 of 16 finalists won no sponsor prize. Finalists = one big, original idea plus depth; sponsors = deepest use of their product.

4. **Sponsor winners use the newest, most specific features:** Uniswap v4 hooks; ENSv2 access-control roles, permissioned and wildcard resolvers; 1inch Aqua/SwapVM with custom opcodes; Hedera x402 agents and tokenization.
5. **Combining sponsors works only when they genuinely depend on each other** (Tokyo: 7 of 29 winners took two or more prizes, e.g. Kura, VexiHakari, Kagi Wallet, UnSui).
6. **Write-ups full of evidence:** test counts, replays of real events, mainnet transactions, measured numbers.
7. **Existing products can win:** IpTOKEN.fun, Novi Corpus, Aqua0, Takarabako. 5 of 32 Tokyo and 13 of 62 ETHOnline sponsor prizes went to continuity projects; continuity prizes stack easily (Aqua0, SoulVault and Lortnoc Tahc each won two).
8. **Each winner explains its problem in one plain sentence** ("Give your AI agent a budget, not your keys").

> **The most crowded idea:** agent spending limits (caps, allowlists, expiry, revoke). At least 15 of the 92 Tokyo/ETHOnline winners did a version of it (Omamoris, LedgerMind, Cordon, Harness, Kagi, Capsule, Batas, Airlock, x402 Guard, Preflight MCP, payOrRefuse...). Fine as a feature, not as a main pitch.

New Delhi 2025: what stood out

Finalist	What it did	Depth then	Depth today
Nox	Private perps via ZK notes in a dark pool (Noir circuits, on-chain verifiers)	Very hard	Still hard
NoNet	Offline transactions hopping phone to phone over Bluetooth (Hedera 1st)	Hard	Still hard
UniPerp	Perp exchange in Uniswap v4 hooks, vAMM, funding oracle (Uniswap 2nd)	Hard	Medium-hard
Dike	Branching prediction markets, Pyth, Self-verified judges	Medium-high	Medium
Autonome	Websites paid per request by AI agents (Polygon x402 1st, The Graph 2nd)	Medium-high	Medium
Igris AI	Security agent with EIP-7702 delegation and dead-man's switch	Medium-high	Medium
ad-402	x402 ad marketplace	Medium	Easy-medium
calendefi	Google Calendar as a wallet (ENS 3rd)	Medium	Easy
KagamiAI	AI copy trading with MCP, Uniswap v4, x402	Medium	Easy-medium
MemeWarp	Cross-chain memecoins with deliberate price gaps	Low	Easy

India-flavoured winners: ShieldRamp (World Mini App 2nd: crypto to rupees via UPI with TEE web proofs), PyPI (Flow 2nd: stablecoins to INR via UPI), ZeroSurf (EF privacy 3rd: ZK age checks with Aadhaar), CrossYield (1inch 2nd: "a modern Laxmi chit fund"), OffGrid Pay, Robin Hood DAO, BondZero (Uniswap 1st: zero-coupon bonds with v4 hooks).

Themes in 2025: x402 agent payments, AI agents doing DeFi, India's own money rails, privacy/ZK, working without internet, new DeFi from v4 hooks.

Depth ratings are judgment calls from code repositories and write-ups. Commit counts (NoNet 100, Dike 101, Nox 56, ad-402 54, Autonome 42, MemeWarp 12) include post-event work; three repos (calendefi, KagamiAI, Igris) were deleted or private.

4. How deep a project has to be

Why the bar moved between 2025 and 2026

- **Sept 2025:** AI coding agents were usable but limited. Claude Code launched in May 2025; GPT-5 and Claude Opus 4.1 came out in August; Claude Sonnet 4.5 was released 29 September, the day after Delhi ended. Wiring five tools together in 36 hours was an achievement.
- **2026:** agents write most of the code (payOrRefuse said Claude wrote most of it; Fiducia ran two coordinating Claude Code sessions). Integration alone is no longer impressive.
- **What still holds value:** real devices and real-world testing, new mechanisms or hard maths, and your own data and proof.

Three levels

Level	What it looks like	Examples	Typically wins now
1. Integration app	Several sponsor tools, clean UI, nothing new underneath	MemeWarp, ad-402	A 3rd place or minor prize at best
2. Working product + one real mechanism	End-to-end, one genuinely original piece	calendefi, Dike, Autonome, Omamoris	Sponsor 1st/2nd; borderline finalist in 2026
3. Something hard, working, with evidence	New mechanism or hard area, fully working, with tests and a measured number	Nox, NoNet, UniPerp, OniBlock, TARE, Kura	**Finalist level in 2026**

> **Target:** a Level 2 product with **one Level 3 component**: one part that is hard, real and proven. Teams at this scale usually fail by building too much and demoing too little, not by aiming too low.

Time budget

- Hacking Thu 9 PM → Sat 9 AM = 36 hours. After sleep (6–8 h each), food and workshops: about 22–26 working hours per person; a team of 4 has about 90–100 person-hours.
- AI speeds up code 2–3×, but not the bottlenecks: sponsor SDK surprises, testnets, device testing, recording.
- Split: 60% core build, 15% integration fixes, 15% demo/video/write-up, 10% buffer.
- **Feature freeze around hour 26 (Friday ~11 PM)**; last 10 hours for testing, measuring and recording.

Finish-line checklist

- Live demo, no hard-coded values
- Each sponsor's feature essential and showable in under 30 seconds
- Contracts deployed, explorer links in the write-up
- A few dozen tests on the core logic
- One number you measured yourselves
- Write-up: problem, how it's built, honest limits; AI usage documented
- 3–4 minute video meeting the rules

- First 30 seconds of the demo open with the problem as a number
- Each sponsor's form section written like a 90-second pitch, with links to the code
- Rehearse the 3 minutes of questions

5. Fiducia: our earlier project

Where it came from

- Built by Dhruv and Vedant for Superteam Germany's **"Build an MVP with Solana at WHU"** (WHU hackathon 2026). Took **3rd of 17** ($500 USDG; 1st Shreyansh Tripathi, 2nd Guido Andreini). Judged on a useful idea, a working prototype, a clear role for Solana and potential to grow.
- Repo: github.com/Mulaydm10/solana-hackathon (411 commits). Live: fiducia-orpin.vercel.app.
- Later extended for the **peaq Machine Economy track** (Crypto World's Fair 2026), with a 12-slide deck, 3-page technical brief and 3-page go-to-market plan (12 Oct).
- Conceptual ancestor: your Crusoe-track win at RAISE (a trust-and-safety control plane for a robot fleet).

What it does

"Fiducia controls how AI agents spend money." One Anchor program (deal_escrow) enforces on-chain mandates: per-payment and total caps, approved payees, stages bound to a plan hash, expiry, one-click revoke. Pieces: data marketplace (assessed, encrypted, escrow), paid services (x402, "no answer, no charge"), agent teams, an MCP server with 17 tools, a demand board, and the peaq machine economy (a simulated delivery robot buying proven kWh from three charging pads, an MCR-style credit score, parametric downtime insurance, Fiducia Insure over x402).

Strengths

- Unusually deep engineering: 636 tests (program 97, agents 325, web 179, MCP 35), 2,000 randomized attack-search runs with 0 invariant violations, the deployed binary verified byte for byte.
- Proof shown, not claimed: a /proof page and explorer links; an over-cap payment refused with OverPerTxCap.
- An honest-limits section; a named first customer and pricing (1.5%, or $149/month + 1%); a concrete reason for Solana (card fees vs about 0.09%).
- The peaq version was focused (one job, one customer), mapped to every track area and reused one escrow for insurance.

Weaknesses we found

- The live demo was broken when checked (catalogue RPC failure, /hire server error, /machines intermittent); the robot's mandate expired on 30 Oct; the 30-minute clock ran on an "always-on Mac".
- The robot's "small business" lost money: $9.00 earned vs $15.77 spent on energy.
- Grades in the deck and on the live page disagreed (robot BB 57 vs AAA 100; pad A BBB 61 vs NR 24); a money-losing robot scored AAA.
- Insurance moral hazard: an unrated pad pays 0.20 for 1.00 cover and could stop heartbeats deliberately to collect.
- The pad signs its own meter reading; peaq events are self-reported (trust level 0).

- No real AI model in the loop; machines simulated; no users or revenue; too many products in one pitch.

Compared with the ETHGlobal winners

- Its core (agent spending mandates) is the most crowded winning idea (Omamoris, LedgerMind, Cordon, Harness, Kagi...).
- Its marketplace pieces overlap with OpenBook, Turnstile, OnchainRouter (same "no answer, no charge" phrase), Carpool, Covenant, Surety and Lifeline.
- **What it uniquely had:** checks both before payment (mandate) and after delivery (hash must match); approvals bound to a specific plan; machine-to-machine payments with insurance and credit (no winner did this); one escrow reused for everything.
- Biggest gap: no real AI being stopped, no finding of its own, self-signed proofs.

Continuity option for Mumbai (not chosen): World Agent Pass continuity $2,500, ENS existing-project up to $2,000, Arkiv existing up to $3,000 + $500: about $8,000 with lighter competition. You decided not to use Fiducia.

6. Every idea we considered

Idea	Sponsors	Ceiling (team of 4)	Status
A. DawaBox: medicine kiosk with verified prescriptions	World, 0G Physical AI, ENS	about $15,500	Parked (hardware, legal sensitivity)
B. Energy-trading Uniswap hook with a charging device	Uniswap, 0G, ENS/CRE	about $14,500	Parked
C. ScamMirror: private scam-address registry	Arkiv, EF, ENS	about $9,000 + finalist	Folded into LeakMeter
D. Voice social trading in Hinglish	0G, Definitive, World IDKit	about $6,000 + finalist	Parked (low ceiling)
HumanFlow: Uniswap hook, lower fees for human-backed agents	World, Uniswap, ENS	about $16,000	**Out (Fables already does the core)**
Bharosa: AI shopping agent for non-crypto families	World, Arc, ENS	about $15,000	Weak ("crowded"; fails the can't-they-just test)
LeakMeter: what your RPC provider learns about you	EF Anon-RPC, Arkiv, ENS	about $13,000	**Live candidate**
NetraPay: phone checks a shop's QR before paying	World, 0G, ENS	about $15,500	**Out (simple fix exists; wrong victim)**
Hedged LP: one-click hedge for ordinary LPs	Uniswap, Definitive, 0G or Arkiv	about $10,000 + finalist	**Live candidate (mentor's direction)**
Warehouse-receipt inspection with a phone	0G, Hedera/Whitechain, ENS	about $8,000 + finalist	Only if a sponsor reacts strongly

The test every idea must pass

> Ask **"can't people just do X?"** If a cheap, obvious X exists and mostly works, the idea is weak. Strong problems are ones where the obvious fix requires trusting someone untrustworthy, doesn't scale, can't be done by the people affected, or needs information that doesn't exist yet.

A. DawaBox (with the proofread fixes)

Problem: prescription-only medicines are routinely sold without valid prescriptions; fake prescriptions and non-existent doctors are common.

1. The doctor signs a QR on the prescription; the kiosk checks it against the doctor's ENSv2 subname (council can revoke; only the doctor can write).
2. A vision model on 0G reads the printed text, matches it to the QR and checks drug conflicts: dispense, refuse or escalate.
3. For a restricted drug, the agent asks the on-call pharmacist for a fresh World ID approval (Agent Pass); the patient's anonymous World ID enforces a monthly per-person limit.
4. The motor dispenses; a fingerprint of the signed QR content (not the photo) is recorded on-chain so reuse is refused.

Flaws fixed in proofreading: World ID can't prove "this is the patient"; vision can't detect forgeries; hashing a photo doesn't stop reuse; 0G may not count a kiosk as a device; a machine dispensing prescription drugs needs a pharmacist in the loop. Crypto needed: no DeFi; basic web3 for the ENS registry and the on-chain fingerprint.

B, C, D in one line each

- **B. Energy hook:** a v4 pool trades energy credits; the hook's fee follows a 0G grid-load forecast (your FlexGrid experience); a real smart plug or Pi rover buys credits.
- **C. ScamMirror:** mirror scam/phishing lists into Arkiv, score how much sources disagree, look up through Anon-RPC.
- **D. Voice trading circles:** Hinglish voice on 0G, group orders through Definitive, World IDKit keeps circles to real people.

The control test

You ran a generic prompt in a fresh session. It researched the prize page but not the winners. Its top pick ("Leash", agent spending limits) was the most crowded winning idea; "Sentinel" (ML dynamic-fee hook) duplicated OniBlock; "Brainbank" targeted 0G Storage, which no Mumbai 0G track rewards, and missed the Arc Studio rule; "Lease.eth" used an off-chain resolver that may not satisfy ENSv2's "central" rule; it missed World's $5,000 track. It did contribute: Lease.eth as a fresh idea, Arkiv's Sub0 data (32 submissions from about 150 hackers), and the logistics (start coding at the event, video rules). Conclusion: the winner analysis, not special creativity, is what improved the ideas.

NetraPay, and why it was dropped

Idea: point your phone at a shop counter; 0G reads the bill and signboard; the QR's payee is checked against the shop's ENSv2-registered payment ID; World ID approval for big or first-time payments; safe stop if 0G is unreachable.

The problem is real:

Year (Lok Sabha reply, Dec 2024)	QR-code fraud cases	Amount
FY 2021–22	14,625	₹19.35 crore
FY 2022–23	30,340	₹41.73 crore
FY 2023–24	39,638	₹56.34 crore
FY 2024–25 (Apr–Sep)	18,167	₹22.22 crore

Sticker-swap cases: Mumbai Khar (July 2025, a guard pasted his QR over paan-shop and vegetable-vendor codes for two months), Khajuraho (Jan 2025, a dozen-plus shops overnight), Hyderabad (July 2024).

Why it's out: UPI already shows the payee name (an existing fix that just needs attention); the shopkeeper loses money, not the customer holding the phone; the core tech is a simple string match; and shops don't take USDC. A judge would raise "people should just check" within 30 seconds.

HumanFlow, and why it's out

Problem (real): LPs lose to arbitrage. The Topaz Blue/Bancor study (May–Sep 2021) found 49.5% of Uniswap v3 LPs lost money vs holding; across 17 pools LPs earned $199M in fees but lost $260M (a $60M net loss). Academic name: loss-versus-rebalancing.

Idea: a v4 hook charges a dynamic premium to arbitrage-like flow and gives human-backed agents (World Agent Pass, ENSv2 subnames, capped per person) a discount.

Why it's out: a Uniswap mentor pointed to **Fables**, a live v4 exchange on Robinhood Chain (Alphix Association) whose fees move with trading hours, volatility, price divergence and trade direction, set by a bounded keeper, "so LPs are paid more when a trade is more likely to be against them". About $23M locked and $1.5B volume in 30 days (DefiLlama, 2 Nov). The only new part left was the identity discount, which was already the weakest part (a verified human can still run arbitrage; ordinary trades often arrive via bots).

LeakMeter (live candidate)

Problem: a wallet's RPC provider sees every address and token you look up, plus your IP and timing, so it can link your wallets and infer holdings without any transaction. Most people can't run their own node. (In 2022 ConsenSys said Infura collects IP and wallet addresses on transactions; from memory, verify before citing.)

1. **Measure:** record your own test wallets' sessions; show step by step what the provider can infer ("after 2 minutes it links these 3 wallets"); a leak score.
2. **Fix:** route lookups through EF's Anon-RPC.
3. **Fix:** mirror public data wallets need (token lists, prices, address labels) into Arkiv.
4. **Prove:** same session again, score drops (e.g. 3 linked wallets → 0).

Sponsors: EF Anon-RPC ($2.5k / $1.5k / $1k), Arkiv Mirror ($3k / $1k + $500), optional ENSv2 privacy-score records (up to $3k). **Why it fits:** own measurement at the centre (like TARE and x402 Guard), no similar winner found, no hardware, suits your ML/data background. **Risk:** less flashy, so the live before-and-after panel must make the leak feel personal.

Hedged LP (the mentor's direction)

The mentor described two kinds of LPs: professionals (market makers, banks, trading firms) and ordinary LPs, and suggested giving ordinary LPs a professional edge without complexity.

Obvious version	Already done by
Auto range moving and fee reinvesting	Arrakis, Gamma, IpTOKEN.fun and others
Copying top LPs	LP Agent (Copy LP, including Uniswap)
Following where professional liquidity sits	Remora Finance (HackMoney 2026)
Higher fees for harmful trades	Fables
Delta-neutral LP via lending	Delta Zero Hook (Delhi, Pyth 2nd)

The unpackaged edge: hedging through advanced orders, in one click. Deposit into a v4 position; as the position drifts toward the falling token, an agent places counter-orders through Definitive's Flash API (limit, stop-loss, TWAP); the user sees one number, "position vs holding, with and without the hedge". Measured finding: replay a real pool and show losses prevented. Sponsors: Uniswap ($4k / $3k / $2k / $1k), Definitive ($2.5k, "Flash paired with another protocol's tools"), plus 0G Agents That Pay for Themselves or Arkiv. Learn from watermark (one signature, hard fences for the agent) and Takarabako (three beginner tiers, one sentence each).

Ask the mentor: "Which pro edge did you mean: hedging, pulling liquidity before big moves, or information?" and "Is anything already doing that for ordinary LPs?"

Phone-to-phone and NFC

- NFC is a transport, not a problem. Prior uses: AccessFi (NFC event payments, EF prize in Delhi), NoNet (Bluetooth, Delhi finalist), Tap Pay (two Android phones as an NFC terminal, Tokyo, no prize). Android can emulate NFC cards easily; iPhones are restricted.
- 0G's Physical AI brief explicitly includes a "pocket device", so a phone qualifies for the main prizes; whether it counts for the $1,000 real-hardware prize is unclear (ask 0G). They want a safe stop when 0G is unreachable, and no faked decisions.
- **Phone idea with a real problem: warehouse-receipt inspection.** Inspector taps a tag, the camera and a 0G vision model check and count goods, a signed record backs a tokenized receipt (Hedera tokenize or Whitechain RWA), inspectors in a revocable ENS registry. India's NSEL scandal involved warehouses that didn't hold the goods (from memory; verify).
- Earlier phone ideas from the voice chat: phone as a robot's eyes with a 0G brain and safe stop; shop-shelf auditor; elderly fall detector.

7. Who to talk to, and what to ask

Catch speakers right after their workshop. Get a Discord handle for questions during hacking. Always ask: "What would make you say wow?" and "Is anything already doing this?"

Who	Questions
Ethereum Foundation (Anon-RPC)	Quickest way to route an app's lookups through Anon-RPC (worker or harness), and the latency? What measurement method of RPC leakage would you trust (own or synthetic sessions)? Must 100% of traffic go through Anon-RPC? Measurement study plus fix, or a better tool?
Arkiv	Are the judging files schema.md, friction.md, reach.md, why-arkiv.md, data-quality.md? What makes a strong reach file? Which datasets do you most want mirrored? Licensing issues with public scam lists? Entity count, size and expiry limits?
ENS	Is our ENSv2 use central enough? Can a contract on another chain read ENSv2 records? Mainnet or Sepolia for judging? What counts as "no hard-coded values"?
Uniswap (for hedged LP)	Which pro edge do ordinary LPs most lack? Anything already doing one-click hedging? Mechanism novelty vs evidence from replaying a real pool? Preferred testnet?
World	How is the $5,000 Agent Pass Portal split? Can an Agent Pass proof be verified on-chain? Is our action "meaningful" by your brief?
0G	Does a phone count as real hardware? What exactly must the Physical AI demo show?
ETHGlobal mentors	Which of our candidates is more finalist-worthy, and why? What did finalist judges reward most last time? What are you tired of seeing?

8. First-hackathon advice and how to decide

- Feeling unsure at your first big hackathon is normal. Reading the projects and briefs yourself is the right instinct: you notice things an AI doesn't.
- **Give yourself a deadline:** pick an idea by around 10 PM tonight. A decent idea built well beats a perfect idea still in your head on Friday.
- **Choose the problem that genuinely bugs you**; that excitement carries you through 36 hours.
- **Test it once on a sponsor or mentor.** If they lean in and start asking questions, that's your answer.

- **You don't need to learn a new field tonight.** Tokyo's vertical ideas came from the founders' own lives (Kura's team collects Magic cards; Takarabako came from leftover travel cash).
- **Use your rare expertise:** you do RF and radar signal-processing research. Enconomy reached the finals with exactly that kind of skill (distance from sound between two phones). Hardly anyone in the hall has it.
- **Exercise (10 minutes):** write down 3 things you know deeply and 3 annoying problems you've had yourself in India or Germany; look for where one meets a sponsor.

> **Decision rule:** choose the candidate where sponsors and mentors gave the most specific, enthusiastic answers. If unclear, LeakMeter is the safest (no similar winner found, lighter tracks, suits your data skills). Keep the team at 3–5 people for the $1,000-per-person finalist tier.

9. Open decisions, next steps and sources

Open decisions

1. LeakMeter or hedged LP (or an idea from your own expertise) by about 10 PM.
2. Team size and who owns which part.
3. Third sponsor pick, and whether ENS is central enough to include.
4. Build track: from scratch (not continuity).

Next steps

1. Talk to EF, Arkiv and the Uniswap mentor before the opening ceremony (8 PM).
2. Decide, then write: the one-sentence problem, the one rule that cannot fail, the headline number and how to reproduce it.
3. Hacking starts 9 PM: core working by hour 20, feature freeze by hour 26, record and submit by Sat 9 AM.

Sources

ETHGlobal Mumbai: ethglobal.com/events/mumbai · /prizes · /info/details (judging and rules) · "What to Expect at ETHGlobal Mumbai" email (2 Nov) · hacker dashboard
Showcases: ethglobal.com/showcase?events=tokyo2026 · ?events=ethonline2026 · ?events=newdelhi · prize pages for tokyo2026, ethonline2026, newdelhi
Project pages cited: OniBlock, TARE, OpenBook, Cordon, Omamoris, yohaku, Kura, watermark, OddsFlow, Takarabako, Enconomy, Patio Station, Novi Corpus, payOrRefuse, IpTOKEN.fun, Nox, NoNet, UniPerp, Dike, Autonome, Igris AI, calendefi, KagamiAI, MemeWarp, ad-402, ShieldRamp, ZeroSurf, Delta Zero Hook, DepegSentinel, MEVengers, Remora Finance, AccessFi, Tap Pay
Fiducia: superteam.fun/earn/listing/build-at-whu · fiducia-orpin.vercel.app · github.com/Mulaydm10/solana-hackathon · Drive folder (peaq pitch deck, technical brief, GTM plan)
QR fraud: MediaNama (Lok Sabha figures, Dec 2024; Khajuraho, Jan 2025) · Free Press Journal (Mumbai Khar arrest, July 2025) · Deccan Chronicle (Hyderabad, July 2024)
LP losses: Cointelegraph on the Topaz Blue / Bancor Uniswap v3 study (Nov 2021) · Drossos et al., arXiv 2501.07828 (2025)
Fables: fables.fi/docs/dynamic-fees · DefiLlama (fables) · IQ.wiki · CandyDrops explainer
LP tools: Solana Compass (LP Agent)
Items marked "from memory" (Infura 2022 disclosure, NSEL scandal, loss-versus-rebalancing paper, 2025 model release dates) were not re-checked in this session.